

CHAPTER FIVE_ Post Abortion Counselling

5.1. Providing Post Abortion Counselling

Post-abortion counselling is a specialized form of counselling that aims to provide emotional support, information, and guidance to individuals who have undergone an abortion. It addresses the physical, emotional, and psychological aspects of the abortion experience. The goal is to help individuals process their feelings, make informed decisions about their reproductive health, and provide them with the necessary tools to move forward. The counselling process should be non-judgmental, confidential, and tailored to the individual's specific needs.

5.1.1. Explanation about Abortion

During post-abortion counselling, the healthcare provider will provide a detailed explanation of what an abortion is. This includes discussing the medical procedure itself, the different methods of abortion, and the reasons why individuals may choose to have an abortion. The information provided should be accurate, objective, and free from any bias or judgment. It is important to address any misconceptions or myths about abortion and clarify any doubts the individual may have.

5.1.2. Counselling Related to Abortion

This stage of counselling focuses on addressing the specific issues and concerns related to the individual's abortion experience. It may involve discussing the following aspects:

5.1.2.1. Cause of Abortion

The healthcare provider may explore the reasons why the individual chose to have an abortion. This can include discussions about personal circumstances, such as financial constraints, relationship issues, health concerns, or other factors that influenced the decision. The purpose is to help the individual understand and process their own motivations and feelings surrounding the abortion.

5.1.2.2. Complications of Abortion

If there were any complications or adverse effects during or after the abortion procedure, the healthcare provider will address them during counselling. They will provide information about

potential complications, their causes, and available treatment options. It is essential to ensure that individuals are aware of the possible risks and know when to seek medical help if needed.

5.1.2.3. Post-Abortion Contraception

During counselling, the healthcare provider will discuss contraception options available to prevent future unintended pregnancies. They will explain different methods of contraception, their effectiveness, and potential side effects. This information empowers individuals to make informed decisions about their reproductive health and choose the contraception method that best suits their needs and preferences.

Informed Consent

Throughout the counselling process, obtaining informed consent is crucial. Informed consent means that the individual has been provided with all the necessary information, including the benefits, risks, and alternatives, and has voluntarily agreed to proceed with the counselling services. The healthcare provider should ensure that the individual understands the purpose, nature, and possible outcomes of the counselling, as well as their right to refuse or discontinue the services at any time.

In summary, post-abortion counselling involves providing a supportive and non-judgmental environment, explaining the abortion procedure, addressing the causes and complications of abortion, discussing post-abortion contraception options, and obtaining informed consent to ensure the individual's autonomy and well-being throughout the counselling process.

5.2. Providing Counselling for STIs & AIDS

Counselling for sexually transmitted infections (STIs) and AIDS plays a critical role in prevention, education, and support. It aims to provide individuals with information about STIs, HIV/AIDS, and promote healthy sexual behaviors. The counselling process involves explaining the importance of voluntary confidential counselling and testing (VCCT), addressing pre-test and post-test considerations, providing guidance on STIs, and discussing contact tracing.

5.2.1. Explanation of VCCT (Voluntary Confidential Counselling & Testing)

VCCT refers to a voluntary and confidential process that offers counselling and testing services for STIs and HIV/AIDS. The purpose of VCCT is to provide individuals with the opportunity to

learn about their sexual health status, receive support, and make informed decisions regarding their healthcare. The following components are involved in VCCT:

5.2.1.1. Pre-test

Pre-test counselling is conducted before the testing process begins. The healthcare provider explains the testing procedures, including the types of tests available, how the tests are performed, and the accuracy of the results. They also discuss the importance of getting tested, the potential risks of STIs and HIV/AIDS, and the available treatment options. Pre-test counselling also includes discussions about risk reduction strategies and ways to prevent the transmission of STIs.

5.2.1.2. Post-test

Post-test counselling is conducted after the testing process is completed and the results are available. The healthcare provider discusses the test results with the individual, providing accurate and clear information. They explain the meaning of the results, addressing any concerns or questions the individual may have. If the test results are positive for an STI or HIV/AIDS, the healthcare provider offers support, guidance, and referrals to appropriate medical services and support groups. They also discuss the importance of treatment, adherence to medication, and steps to prevent further transmission.

5.2.2. STIs Counselling

STIs counselling involves providing information, education, and guidance on sexually transmitted infections. The healthcare provider discusses various topics related to STIs, including:

5.2.2.1. Contact Tracing

Contact tracing is a process where the healthcare provider assists individuals in identifying and notifying their sexual partners who may have been exposed to an STI. The provider explains the importance of contact tracing in preventing the spread of STIs and encourages individuals to take responsible actions to protect their partners' health. They provide guidance on how to approach contact tracing, maintain confidentiality, and offer support throughout the process.

In summary, counselling for STIs and AIDS involves explaining the VCCT process, addressing pre-test and post-test considerations, providing guidance on STIs, and discussing contact tracing. The aim is to educate individuals about STIs and HIV/AIDS, promote safe sexual practices, offer

support, and ensure the confidentiality and well-being of the individuals seeking counselling and testing services.